

Have an open mind and look at what's new, but think about whether this new technology actually will serve your needs. It's fine if it doesn't.

Q. How can a developer find projects to contribute to while keeping away from the hype?

A. There's nothing wrong with working on a hype project, but you have to make sure that you actually have interest. Think small — don't expect to become the main contributor in the next two weeks or in a short span.

Remember most of the open source projects really like non-code contributions just as much, such as testing or reporting bugs or lack of information in the documentation. Don't just go into it to write some code. Initially have some idea about which area you want to contribute to. It should be something that excites you. Go to GitHub and just read through project contributing guidelines. It will tell you what contributions the project needs and how to make them correctly.

Your work may be small, like adding a sentence to the doc or correcting a typo. But it will allow you to get familiar with the process and with the other people involved in these projects. Do not expect to jump into a project and change its core. Most likely, only an approved committee of committers can actually change that part of the code. Build some trust, show that you understand the project and over time your involvement will grow naturally.

Q. Any examples of projects you think were overrated because they had just used a new technology?

A. I have seen a few working in the database space. When you think about it, relational databases have been around for a very long time and are still going strong. To some extent,

we have forgotten why relational databases became so popular. The goal was to organise the data in a way so that five years from now somebody who comes in and has no clue what the data looked like, can make sense out of it. For a while there was a general hype that you no longer need any database, whether relational or non-relational, because Hadoop will do everything. And it didn't. It actually just led to data cleansing issues for many folks. Don't get me wrong — there are companies that successfully run Hadoop clusters and there is nothing bad about the technology itself. But you have to understand what it is and when to use it.

Q. Oracle has recently introduced the new MongoDB API for its autonomous database. What was the reason behind it and how did it happen?

A. At Oracle, we follow the converged database methodology. This methodology focuses on bringing the algorithms and computation to the data, rather than the other way around. A very good analogy for converged database methodology is the smartphone, where you can do multiple use cases in one device, like taking a picture and sending it to a friend while being on a phone call, for example. In recent years, we have seen a proliferation of vendors pitching their technology to address an often simple use case. For example, developers like working with JSON documents and MongoDB allows them to store and retrieve these documents. But it is one thing to store and retrieve these and another to analyse terabytes of them in real-time. We think SQL is a really good language for any kind of analytics and we have the best database for mixed workloads, i.e., allow real-time analytics while transactional workloads are running. Additionally,

Oracle Database has been managing JSON documents natively since 2014.

Developers love the MongoDB API as it makes database interaction very natural for them. And we have the best database for analytics and mixed workloads that can also manage JSON documents natively. So we decided to give developers the best of both worlds — the same MongoDB API on top of the world's leading database.

Q. Will you say MongoDB is a new hype?

A. The JSON format is a very useful hierarchical format and is nothing new — it's been around since 2001. If you want to use JSON, then go ahead, by all means. Oracle has done a lot of work to introduce JSON operations into the SQL standard, and we see more and more databases supporting these standardised operations. You will find that if you want to work with JSON, retrieve JSON documents, query and manipulate data in JSON documents, you definitely don't need to have a document store anymore. MongoDB is a cool technology, but so were XML databases in their days. I think it is definitely not needed for data management aspects.

Q. Any hiring plans?

A. We are constantly hiring great talent and all our openings can be accessed on the Oracle careers page. We are looking for people in a variety of different roles, including engineering and product management. We are strong in diversity and have people from all around the world and all ages, including graduate students.

Q. Your message for our readers.

A. Programming is a universal language and it's great to be a developer and write programs. Don't be shy, be always ready to try something new and get out of your comfort zone to do things you are passionate about. **END** 🐧